

year there have been records shattered. Not only the Majors, but there are also tournaments like IEM Cologne, which get as much hype



SOURCE: VALVE

as the hype has Valve-sponsored events. Each tournament since the very first one, has been a celebration of the spirit of the game, where the best of CS:GO's community meet and show the world the might of this 'dying' game.

THE COMMUNITY

The heart and soul of any game, the CS:GO community is practically what there is in CS:GO. Be it online or offline, the community has stayed string over the years. Heck, some members from the CS community had gotten featured in the game to, as creators of maps and stickers. Even when music kits were introduced in the game, Valve looked towards the community to source some music kits. The latest introduction in this category is the music kit titled, "Headed for the source" by a CS:GO YouTuber, 3klikphilip.

While the community of CS:GO has grown exponentially in the last few years, with the game breaking the record for being the game with most concurrent active players in 2020, there have been multiple instances where Valve has turned a blind eye to the community. Fire-up Reddit and go to r/GlobalOffensive, and you will find countless posts with feedback for Valve. However, sometimes it seems that the voice isn't reaching Valve despite peaking-out on the decibel scale.

THE SECOND FIDDLE

Staying on the topic of Valve not listening to the community, let's talk about the apparent double standards that Valve holds for the game. Look at the changes and attention that DOTA 2 has received, compared to CS:GO. The game has Valve funded million-dollar tournaments and has also seen an engine overhaul. Then there is CS:GO. A decade old game, that has a legion of fans asking for an engine update for years now, and a better match-making system. But all that they get in return are visually updated chickens. Quite literally.



SOURCE: VALVE

It is CS:GO's 10-year anniversary, right? Look at what Valve served the players:

- A sticker capsule with community-made stickers,
- Five community-made maps,
- Visually updated chickens, and custom birthday themed bomb-defusal, and zeus sounds, and

- A 10-year commemorative in-game coin that was literally a cupcake, topped with a chicken-coin.

Just look at it. Out of the four announcements, half of them were made by the community. All that Valve developers had to do was reprogram the visuals and sound cues for a couple of items, give

chickens top hats, and create a coin, which by the way, people have said that they did a very bad job of, and we concur. By now, you might be thinking that this quickly turned into an open letter to Valve, but that is what the reality of the whole situation, unfortunately.

DIFFUSING

Like the 10-second timer in game, we are running out of space to say anything more at this point. We did not want to end this piece on a bitter note. However, whatever we wrote was from the perspective of a journalist, who is also a fan of the game. And, right now, this is what the reality is. CS:GO is a game that everyone, every year says that it has run its course, but it somehow ends up exceeding expectations. Expectations that may seem too easy to exceed, but actually are quite high. We have found a family in the CS:GO community, and a home in de_dust2.

You might have noticed that we did not write much about the actual game, because after a solid 10-year run, you do not need a review of the



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TheKasbah

gameplay. The verdict is already out on that. All you need is a collection of memories, celebrating the highs and commenting on the lows. And that is what this article was supposed to be.

Here's to 10 more years of rushing B and asking for the big green... Happy belated birthday, CS:GO! ✨